Somewhere in Germany

By Buzzy Enniss

INTRODUCTION

What defines a person? Is it our DNA, where we grew up, or is it the family we are born into? I am struck by the question of what is an identity. Who are we without the people, places and things that surround us? Does my name define me, the place I live or the family I come from? Does my country or the planet define me? Who does God say I am? Will that answer suffice when all around me seems changed? Buzzy Enniss explores this concept of how a person is defined in his poem "Somewhere in Germany."

Somewhere in Germany

A woman invented a thing.

A thing that you do not yet know about.

She invented a microscope so powerful that it can sink

directly past skin

And look deeper into cells than ever before.

4NG Fanatics

Now you know about the thing.

It has revealed that people are actually made up of words.

Baffled doctors and embarrassed scientists

Have completed the connection of this microscope to a monitor.

The insecure are running frantically to wait in the line that leads to the lens

That will display their hopefully amazing words on the monitor.

Many people have ended up feeling sad as they realize their words are the same as

The person's right before them and directly after them.

JEANS, COFFEE, TV, next please

JEANS, COFFEE, TV, next please

JEANS, COFFEE, BOOKS – Hey, congratulations!

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

Some are confused because their words are in a foreign language.
They've got Sanskrit fingernails scratching hieroglyphic foreheads
As they frustratedly pull Swahili out of their scalp

They are learning that most people are simply misspelled and psychiatrists are trying to decode this new human alphabet.
[Most psychiatrists are made of the word EXPENSIVE]

Some walked away proud knowing that their skin
is made from copies of War and Peace
and Tolstoy is cramming marathons into their shells.

A few ladies had sonnets falling from their hair and pretty haiku inside their eyelids.

One man had an entire back of free verse poetry and his left leg rhymed with his right.

4NG Fanatics

One man's stomach was actually the recipe for cheap beer.
A few discovered that they are comprised of all punch lines and they have begun searching for those made up of all jokes.

In God We Trust is a very popular kneecap.

Countless noses are incorrect definitions of the word pretty
while one child's earlobe was made up of phrases that convinced her she could be a ballerina:

You can do it, you can do anything.

Most babies are blurred words from their mothers' forearms
While others were sadly blank.

This lens holds the memories of past victories and sins' words worked into our skins and deeper:

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

The microscope zooms to the top layer and
reveals who you are dating
and what you really think of them.
It zooms deeper and displays how you really feel
about your parents.
It zooms deeper and reminds you about the
people you still haven't forgiven.
Deeper and you remember how you felt about God
before you went to
college.
Deeper and you can remember your first
birthday.

And then it gets to your core,
into the most sacred word you hold.

It is at this point that most people look away from the
monitor,
take a breath,
And exhale relief when they look back and see that it is
actually a very good word.

4NG Fanatics

People soon cry the word fear,
sweat the word pleasure,
Yawn the word ready,
Whistle the word thinking.

When they stretch, their muscles read
MY GOD I'M OUT OF SHAPE

I watched an old man quietly and slowly inch his way
under the lens.
He disrobed, stood naked and still with his eyes
clenched.
The monitor repeated itself with every movement of the
lens;
Forgive me . . . forgive me . . . forgive me
And please God, let me in.

But I, myself am choosing to wait my turn
until the interest and curiosity of the public dissipates.
That is when I will sneak into the lab
where the Microscope Light Enhancer 2000 is resting on

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

glossy moon tiles,
I will turn it on.

The monitor might flash a couple of times to warm up as
I step under the lens
It will begin to spill what I hope to be an important
dictionary onto the screen.

While I am waiting patiently for my words to appear,
I will begin to write down my best guesses of what my
words will be:
An honest list of flaws, triumphs,
Lessons learned with ease,
embarrassing memories,
things I have never been and now want to be,
sins, new habits to begin, sacred friendships gone and
wasted,
love, Dad, my blood is no longer bad,
Mom's humor in my veins
the result of generational broken chains . . .

4NG Fanatics

Before I finish my list, I will turn everything off and
leave.
I will want to smash it all and leave a note that says
nobody needs this machine

but I won't,
I will leave it alone,
and go somewhere beautiful
and finish my list myself.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Buzzy Enniss
Book: Letting Myself Go
ISBN: 978-0978998943
Publisher: Write Bloody Publishing
Date (Month/Year): March 2007

AWARD HISTORY

2010 National Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY